

David Trick

Software UX Designer · Persona-Driven Research, Design Systems, AI-Augmented Build | Greater Seattle Area
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Professional Summary

Software UX designer with 9+ years at AWS leading the user experience for a data center monitoring platform used and supported by 20+ teams across AWS's global data center fleet. Sole UX designer responsible for the platform's vision, standards, design systems, research, and cross-team UX coordination. Specializes in **persona-driven research and design** as the method for taking a multi-role industrial product from one-size-fits-all toward role-specific interface logic — generating persona candidates, validating with field customers, and incorporating the results into shipped pages.

BFA in Graphic Design + BS in Mechanical Engineering. Works in design systems, software engineering (React/TypeScript, GraphQL, AWS CDK), and AI-augmented workflows — turning design decisions into shipped, standards-compliant code.

Core Competencies: UX Design · Design Systems & Standards · Persona-Driven Research · Cloudscape · Figma & Figma Make · React/TypeScript · GraphQL · AWS CDK · AI Agent Design · Accessibility (WCAG) · Visual Design · Branding & Typography · 3D Modeling · Industrial HMI · BMS/EPMS/SCADA

Professional Experience

Design Technologist II — Amazon Web Services

August 2022 – Present | Greater Seattle Area

Sole UX designer for AWS's data center infrastructure monitoring platform. Responsible for all user experience design, design systems, research, and cross-team UX coordination for a web-based product used by operations engineers, field technicians, controls engineers, deployment engineers, and operations leaders.

UX Vision, Standards & Design Systems

- Authored 3-layer UX tenets and standards document — 15 design tenets → 19 standard tenets → 17 component specs — synthesized from 6 source documents as the platform's single source of truth
- Completed UX Audit Program — all 42 platform pages audited, then re-audited against tenet-based Schema v2.5.1 (103 machine-checkable rules across 13 page types + 15 page-type exceptions, every rule traceable to a specific design tenet); **6 rules recommended for CI enforcement** (*pending*)
- Built a standalone UX Standards Website (React/Cloudscape) — first dedicated UX standards reference for the platform and a sandbox vehicle for persona-based dashboards; its reference content has since been consolidated into the team wiki

- Cross-organization terminology standardization across 4 organizations; 6 naming decisions adopted platform-wide
- Team's UI/UX approver on cross-team code reviews — design-system compliance, accessibility, and persona-impact callouts as a recurring contribution
- Defined the complete UX roadmap (5 workstreams, 19 epics) and presented to leadership; **secured Q2 direction with persona-driven design as the execution focus**

Persona-Driven Research & Design (*specialization*) End-to-end persona lifecycle for the platform — generation of new persona candidates, structured validation with customers, and incorporation into shipped product. Treats personas not as documents but as the substrate that drives default sort orders, conditional widgets, role-detection logic, and the bidirectional persona ↔ feature dependency map.

- Documented **20 personas across 6 job-family categories** with confidence scoring (High/Medium/Low) keyed to validation source quality; default sort surfaces gaps and prioritizes outreach
- Defined a **sub-persona promotion framework** (single-voice → substantiated → verified) so role variants from different regions, deployment models, or operational contexts can be tracked and graduated as customer evidence accumulates
- Ran a **structured customer validation program** — 6 review documents, ~112 non-jargon questions, an unbiased feedback channel (engineering excluded); drove multiple platform-wide design decisions including status display preferences and terminology choices
- Built a **page-level change matrix** mapping current platform pages to per-persona behavior (default sort, default columns, hidden vs. visible elements, surfaced metadata, conditional widgets); each row tied to a specific verified pain point and tier
- Built **4 interactive persona landing-page dashboards** with draggable widget layouts and operational variants
- Authored north-star design vision: **widget-based atomic units → persona-templated dashboards → deep-dive experiences**, with all 20 personas mapped to default templates and a defined customization lifecycle
- Presented the dashboards live on the reference-site sandbox to immediate leadership — first leadership exposure to the persona-driven UX vision **as a working UX model** rather than static mockups

AI-Augmented Design-to-Build

- Built an **AI development agents package** with 39 validated capabilities (16 skills, 1 agent, 3 SOPs, 19 context files) approved by the team; created a unified audit-aware page generator producing standards-compliant React/Cloudscape from natural-language descriptions
- Pioneered **Figma Make → React rapid prototyping pipeline**; 6 AI-generated mockups translated into 4 interactive persona dashboard implementations
- Designed an **AI-powered sprint management system** where agents autonomously manage boards, create punt clones, and track velocity
- Standards violations now affect code reviews with persona feedback shipping as non-blocking advisory cards

Cross-Team Enablement

- Authored 3 formal training modules and delivered an in-person 2.5-hour Figma training to a partner graphics engineering team to distribute basic design capability

- Contributed to 2025 platform launches as team member: full-text search GA on the inventory system (devices, sites, alarms, documents), and the platform's v1 → v2 generation shift (underlying data-structure migration plus the metric-organization tooling that improved how users interact with configurations); both back-end initiatives, with heavier participation on the metric-organization side where the UX interactions lived
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Controls Design Engineer — Amazon Web Services

April 2017 – August 2022 | Greater Seattle Area

Hired as Graphics Engineer; promoted to L5 in December 2018; progressed through multiple levels of Controls Design Engineering before transitioning to Design Technologist.

- Built the **global automation controls graphics deployment program** from the ground up — the cross-team workflow for creating, reviewing, and deploying SVG artwork for AWS data center HMIs worldwide; 3 ticketing templates still in active use
 - Co-created the **Controls GUI Style Guide** — the grayscale graphics standards package that established visual consistency across all AWS data centers globally; still in active use 8+ years later
 - Established the **centralized Graphics Repository** for completed SVG artwork across all sites and authored the definitive SVG floorplan annotation runbook (shared 7+ times to onboard team members)
 - Audited BMS graphics across all legacy US data centers against 62 graphical standard elements; produced a ROI-ranked 3-phase remediation program sized at a multi-work-year effort and pitched it to senior leadership
 - Automated the floorplan creation pipeline by replacing the PDF-based workflow with direct CAD file processing — **60% reduction** in average generation time across two optimization phases
 - Designed the graphical interface for a **1MW modular electrical distribution system** with 10-inch touchscreen EPMS, submitted to manufacturer for global production reproduction
 - Designed and built a **7-page colocation HMI template** adopted for international colocation site deployments
 - Reviewed BMS and power-monitoring vendor graphic submittals for global sites (US, Europe, Asia-Pacific) against AWS controls standards
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Earlier Experience

Curriculum Developer & Instructor — Blaze Education, Inc. (*Jan 2017 – Mar 2017, Redmond, WA*)

Developed curriculum standards and course materials for Game Development and 3D Printing classes; instructed students on 3D modeling, design thinking, and rapid prototyping.

Design Engineer — UW Hyperloop (*Mar 2016 – Aug 2016, Seattle, WA*) Designed test cell apparatus for magnetic-levitation thrust vector measurement using strain gauges; created CAD models and engineering drawings; collaborated on conceptual design for the Hyperloop transportation system.

Teaching Assistant & Lab Assistant — University of Washington, ME Department (*Sep 2014 – Dec 2015*) Lab TA for Mechanical Engineering courses; assigned team design exercises, graded labs, proctored exams; supported Composites, Machine Shop, and Learning Labs.

Freelance Designer (May 2010 – Sep 2017) Created and owned Syncopated Design until Sept 2014

Provided full-spectrum design services across logo design and branding, typography, journal and book design, website creation and maintenance, animation, and user interface/experience design for clients across diverse industries.

Featured Projects

UX Standards Website (Owner, 2026 — content since consolidated into the team wiki) Standalone

reference site that serves a dual purpose: documents the platform's UX standards (page types, components, audit rules, accessibility requirements) and provides a customer-interactive and customizable mockup for persona-based landing page dashboards. Consolidated data to a team wiki for inclusion, maintenance, and closer collaboration once website was decommissioned.

AI-Powered Page Auditing Agent (Owner, 2026) Custom AI agent for automated auditing of platform pages against design and coding standards; published as a shared team package — affects code reviews on standards violations while keeping persona feedback as non-blocking suggestions.

Education

Bachelor of Science, Mechanical Engineering — University of Washington (2014 – 2016, GPA 3.42)

Capstone: EcoCar (machining, SolidWorks drawings, manufacturing of connective components).

Independent research: UW Hyperloop test bench design for magnetic levitation. ASME and ASHRAE student member. Honors: Roy & Irene Grossman Memorial Scholarship; Roy C. Fellows Endowed Scholarship (Sept 2015).

Bachelor of Fine Arts, Visual Communications — Graphic Design — University of Arizona (2002 –

2008, GPA 3.84, Magna Cum Laude) Additional emphasis in Motion Graphics. Member of IEEE.

Certifications

- **Figma Essential Training: The Basics** — LinkedIn Learning (April 2022)
 - **Revit: MEP Families** — LinkedIn Learning (August 2021)
 - **Cert Prep: Revit Architecture Certified Professional** — LinkedIn Learning
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Technical Skills

Design & UX: Figma, Figma Make, Cloudscape Design System, Adobe Creative Suite (Illustrator, Photoshop, InDesign), Inkscape, design systems, prototyping, wireframing, accessibility (WCAG), persona research, customer validation **Front-End:** React, TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML5, CSS3, SVG, D3.js, component architecture, state management, responsive design **Back-End & Cloud:** GraphQL, Java, Python, AWS CDK, CloudFront, Route 53, ACM, S3, Lambda, REST APIs **AI & Automation:** Kiro (AI-powered IDE), Amazon Q, AI agent design, AI capabilities packaging, workflow automation **3D / CAD:** SolidWorks, Revit, AutoCAD, 3D printing, additive manufacturing, technical drawing **Industrial:** BMS, EPMS, SCADA, HMI, PLC, Ignition Systems

Languages

English: Native proficiency

Volunteer Experience

Security Officer — Baha'i World Centre (*May 2003 – May 2004, Haifa and Akka, Israel*) Maintained security presence and coordinated with local guards across a multicultural environment alongside 750+ international volunteers; performed gate, building, and grounds checks; volunteered additionally in gardening, facilities, and visitor guidance.

Professional Recommendation

"David is a talented mechanical engineer. He is responsible, hard-working, and a team-player. His passion for engineering learning goes beyond the classroom." — **Nate Sniadecki**, Professor at University of Washington (*November 2016*)